

metrics

► 38°C (100 Farenheit)

Intel Pentium III 1000

AMD Athlon 1400

► 370°C (698 Farenheit)

The temperature of the processor after the Heatsink and CPU fan is removed from the processor.

Source: Tom's Hardware Guide

Realplayer to go Mobile

Texas Instruments has decided to incorporate RealPlayer Mobile, a wireless version of the popular digital media software for the PC, into its chips for wireless devices. This would allow manufacturers to offer streaming media playback on mobile devices like cell phones and handhelds.

This would allow wireless service operators and hand-

set manufacturers to send news and entertainment content on RealPlayer's mobile digital media player. The software will be optimised for TI's OMAP architecture, which boasts of high-performance at low power usage. Support for RealPlayer Mobile is expected to be available in the first quarter of 2002.

Stirring up a Mindstorm

Lego's successful Mindstorm digital toys have stirred up a lot of debate recently. The company, which is famous for its educational toys, found that some ingenious Mindstorms's users went and modified some of the proprietary code. This was then posted on the Internet, and people have begun writing their own software for the robots. There is even a completely new operating system called LegOS written for the toy. It seems likely that while Lego might not do anything to

stop people from 'customising' their toys, it will take steps to

ensure that their patents are not exploited.



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Gizmos' graveyard

Most gadgets that die are unceremoniously dumped in landfills. The European Commission wants manufacturers of everything from TVs and computers to mobile phones to take back and recycle up to 90 per cent of their products by 2006.

Recycling is especially difficult with small intricate devices where dismantling is often difficult or impossible. A team of researchers at Brunel University have devised a way to use smart

materials to make discarded mobile phones or computers pop apart on request. Their components—circuit boards, screens, switches and the like—will sort themselves into separate piles.

They are pinning their hopes on a technique called active disassembly using smart materials (ADSM). It relies on the unusual properties of shape memory alloys (SMAs) and shape memory polymers (SMPs). The new fasteners will pop out when they are

heated to the preset temperature. Later, products can be designed from scratch with ADSM in mind.

Manufacturers are bound to take advantage of the consumer appeal afforded by these products. Fancy a phone that is discreet and businesslike all week, but becomes jazzy and bright for the weekend? Just pop it under the grill for a few seconds. Then on Sunday night, another quick blast could sober it up, ready for work on Monday morning.

Who is?

Alexey Pajitnov

▲ Who is he?

He is famous for inventing one of the the most addictive games of the century, *Tetris*, which set a record of sorts by selling 50 million licensed copies.

Inspired to become a mathematician in order to enjoy the puzzles, he also developed a game called *Genetic Engineering* prior to *Tetris*. He says that the idea and the balance of mechanics is the secret behind the success of any game.

▲ Why is *Tetris* popular?

At the time it was launched, it did not have much real competition. Besides this, the gameplay really appealed to a wide group of people that found that it required a combination of speed of thought and the ability to match patterns in the blocks.

Hence *Tetris* was prescribed by doctors for kids over 12 years to develop their thinking ability.

▲ Where to look for more?

To learn more about *Tetris* and for stories related to the game, logon to www.tetris.com or just enter the word 'Tetris' in any one of the popular search engines.